



ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

GENERAL STUDIES (P) TEST – 3785 (2023)

Q 1.A

- Freedom of Religion is a Fundamental Right provided under Articles 25-28 of the Constitution. Freedom of religion also includes the freedom of conscience. This means that a person may choose any religion or may choose not to follow any religion. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Freedom of Religion includes the right to not just practice one's religion but also to propagate it. This includes persuading people to join one's religion and willful conversion from one religion to another. The Constitution bars forceful conversions and conversions done by inducements. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Freedom of Religion is available to not just Indian citizens but also to foreign nationals residing within Indian territory. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 2.C

- **Article 360 empowers the President to proclaim a Financial Emergency if he is satisfied that a situation has arisen due to which the financial stability or credit of India or any part of its territory is threatened.** The 38th Amendment Act of 1975 made the satisfaction of the President in declaring a Financial Emergency final and conclusive and not questionable in any court on any ground. But, this provision was subsequently deleted by the 44th Amendment Act of 1978 implying that the satisfaction of the President is not beyond judicial review.
- **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

Q 3.D

- Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change has recently released the 'India State of Forest Report 2021'. It provides information on forest cover, tree cover, mangrove cover, growing stock, carbon stock in India's forests, forest fire monitoring, forest cover in tiger reserve areas, above ground estimates of biomass in Indian forests.
- **Statement 1 is not correct:** It is published biennially (and not annually) by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MOEFCC) which is prepared by the Forest Survey of India (FSI). It has been mandated to assess the forest and tree resources of the country.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** As per the reported increase of 2,261 sq km in the total forest and tree cover of the country in the last two years. As compared to the assessment of 2019, there is an increase of 2,261 sq km in the total forest and tree cover of the country. An increase in forest cover has been observed in the open forests followed by very dense forests.
- **Statement 3 is not correct: Maximum increase in forest cover witnessed in Andhra Pradesh (647 sq km)** followed by Telangana (632 sq km) and Odisha (537 sq km). Area-wise Madhya Pradesh has the largest forest cover in the country followed by Arunachal Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, and Maharashtra.

Q 4.C

The features of parliamentary government in India are:

- Presence of nominal and real executives;
- **Majority party rule,**
- Collective responsibility of the executive to the legislature,
- Membership of the ministers in the legislature,
- Leadership of the prime minister or the chief minister,

- Dissolution of the lower House (Lok Sabha or Assembly).

There are some differences between the British Parliamentary system and that of India. For example, the **Indian Parliament is not a sovereign body like the British Parliament**. Also, the **Indian State has an elected head (republic) while the British State has hereditary head (monarchy)**.

Q 5.A

- The Composition of the NITI Aayog is as follows:
 - **Chairperson:** The Prime Minister of India
 - **Governing Council:** It comprises the Chief Ministers of all the States, Chief Ministers of Union Territories with Legislatures (i.e., Delhi and Puducherry) and Lt. Governors of other Union Territories.
 - **Regional Councils:** These are formed to address specific issues and contingencies impacting more than one state or a region. These are formed for a specified tenure. These are convened by the Prime Minister and comprises of the Chief Ministers of States and Lt. Governors of Union Territories in the region. These are chaired by the Chairperson of the NITI Aayog or his nominee.
 - **Special Invitees:** Experts, specialists and practitioners with relevant domain knowledge as special invitees nominated by the Prime Minister.
 - **Full-time Organisational Framework:** It comprises, in addition to the Prime Minister as the Chairperson:
 - ✓ **Vice-Chairperson:** He is appointed by the Prime Minister. He enjoys the rank of a Cabinet Minister.
 - ✓ **Members:** Full-time. They enjoy the rank of a Minister of State.
 - ✓ **Part-time Members:** Maximum of 2, from leading universities, research organisations and other relevant institutions in an ex-officio capacity. Part-time members would be on a rotation.
 - ✓ **Ex-Officio Members:** Maximum of 4 members of the Union Council of Ministers to be nominated by the Prime Minister.
 - ✓ **Chief Executive Officer:** He is appointed by the Prime Minister for a fixed tenure, in the rank of Secretary to the Government of India.
 - ✓ **Secretariat:** As deemed necessary.

Q 6.D

- **Statement 1 correct:** Unlike the USA, where it has two sets of constitutions for center and states, India has a single constitution for both states and center. The Indian constitution is also flexible unlike the case of a true federation where it will be rigid. This is a centralizing tendency as states boundaries can be altered by the center.
- **Statement 2 correct:** The candidates selected for All India services were recruited and trained by the center but are to be served in the states, which do not have the capacity to 'remove' them.
- **Statement 3 correct:** The governor having many discretionary powers at the state is appointed by the center. This is one of the major centralizing tendencies.

Q 7.B

- The first phase of the census and collection of details to update the National Population Register (NPR) have been postponed at least till September 2022.
- **The NPR is a list of "usual residents of the country".**
- According to the Home Ministry, a "usual resident of the country" is one who has been residing in a local area for at least the last six months or intends to stay in a particular location for the next six months.
- NPR is not a citizenship enumeration drive, as it would record even a foreign national staying in a locality for more than six months.
- **This makes NPR different from the NRC, which includes only Indian citizens while seeking to identify and exclude non-citizens. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The NPR is being prepared under provisions of the Citizenship Act, 1955 and the Citizenship (Registration of Citizens and issue of National Identity Cards) Rules, 2003.
- **It is mandatory for every "usual resident of India" to register in the NPR. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- Only Assam will not be included (as per a notification by the Registrar General of India in August), given the recently completed NRC in that state
- NPR will be conducted in conjunction with the house-listing phase, the first phase of the Census, by the Office of Registrar General of India (RGI) for Census 2021.
- It is conducted at the local, sub-district, district, state and national levels.

- The data for NPR was first collected in 2010 along with the house-listing phase of Census 2011. Hence statement 3 is correct.
- In 2015, this data was updated by conducting door-to-door surveys.

Q 8.D

- In 1973, the Supreme Court ruled in **Kesavananda Bharati case** that **there is a basic structure of the Constitution and nobody—not even the Parliament (through amendment)—can violate the basic structure**. The Court did two more things. First, it said that right to property (the disputed issue) was not part of basic structure and therefore could be suitably abridged. Secondly, the **Court reserved to itself the right to decide whether various matters are part of the basic structure of the Constitution**. This case is perhaps the best example of how judiciary uses its power to interpret the Constitution.

Q 9.C

- **Recently, the former Reserve Bank of India (RBI) governor Urjit Patel has been appointed vice-president of the Beijing-based Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB).**
- **The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)** is a multilateral development bank that aims to improve economic and social outcomes in Asia.
- AIIB's President and Board of Directors have approved 167 projects.
- Project approval was guided by the Bank's strategic goals and thematic priorities.
- AIIB has 105 members and is open to accepting additional members.
- AIIB is headquartered in Beijing, China.
- **The AIIB, launched in Beijing in 2015, has approved more loans for India than any other member of the bank.**
- The AIIB has funded 28 projects in India amounting to \$6.7 billion.
- Initially, 70-80% of the projects were co-financed but now that share of projects is standalone.
- **China is its biggest shareholder and India is the second-largest. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The U.S.A and Japan are not among its members. Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 10.A

- Democracy as a form of government only ensures that people take their own decisions. This does not guarantee that their decisions will be good. People can make mistakes. Involving the people in these decisions does lead to **delays in decision making**. It is also true that democracy leads to **frequent changes in leadership**. Sometimes this can set back big decisions and affect the government's efficiency.
- **Democracy may lead to corruption for it is based on electoral competition due to more expenditure in elections, criminalisation of politics, etc.**
- Democracy is based on consultation and discussion. A democratic decision always involves many persons, discussions and meetings. When a number of people put their heads together, they are able to point out possible mistakes in any decision. This takes time. But there is a big advantage in taking time over important decisions. This **reduces the chances of rash or irresponsible decisions**. Thus democracy improves the quality of decision-making.

Q 11.C

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Fundamental rights can be amended by constitution amendment till they do not violate the basic structure of the constitution and thus they are not sacrosanct.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** are available against the actions of both State and private individuals. Few Rights like Abolition of Untouchability etc are available against private citizens also.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** These rights limit the power of the Executive and legislature and thus prevent tyranny of the executive and legislature.

Q 12.C

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Supreme Court in 1992 stated that Fundamental duties can be used in determining the constitutionality of any law.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Parliament is free to enforce Fundamental duties through suitable legislation. Many legislations like the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971 make insult to national symbols a punishable act.

Q 13.C

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Though the word "Secular" was not added to the Preamble initially, the Indian Constitution has been secular from the beginning. It has Freedom of Religion (Art 25-28) and Protection of rights of minorities (Art 29-30) as Fundamental Rights. However, Indian secularism is

different from the Western concept of secularism, where religion is treated as a personal matter and there is a strict separation between religion and State. In India, State can regulate economic, political, and secular activities related to religious practices, for example- throwing open Hindu religious institutions to all sections.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** As per Art 29(2), no citizen can be denied entry into any educational institute maintained by the State only on the grounds of religion, race, caste, or any of them.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The Freedom of Religion is not absolute. The Constitution provides for certain limitations on them. For example, every religious denomination has the right to establish and maintain institutions for religious and charitable purposes. But this is subject to restrictions of public order, morality, and health.

Q 14.B

- Cases related to dispute/conflict between Fundamental Right and Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSPs) -:
 - Champakam Dorairajan Case, 1951 - In this case, Supreme Court ruled that in case of any conflict between FRs and DPSPs, FRs would prevail. It declared that DPSPs have to conform to and run as subsidiaries to the fundamental right. However, it also held that FRs could be amended by the Parliament through constitutional amendment acts. This led to the First, Fourth, and Seventeenth Amendment Act to implement some of the DPSPs.
 - **Golak Nath case, 1967** - In this case, Supreme Court held that Parliament can't take away or abridge any of the Fundamental Rights, which are 'sacrosanct' in nature. Hence, the court held that Fundamental Rights can't be amended for the implementation of DPSPs. This led to the enactment of the 24th Amendment Act and the 25 amendment Act which inserted a new Article 31C.
 - Kesavanand Bharti case, 1973 - In this case, Supreme Court declared the second provision of Article 31C as unconstitutional and invalid on the ground that judicial review is a basic feature of the Constitution. This led to the enactment of the 42nd Amendment Act which gave legal primacy and supremacy to the DPSPs over FRs conferred by Articles 14, 19, and 21.
 - **Minerva Mills case, 1980** - In this case, Supreme Court held the primacy of DPSPs over FRs as unconstitutional and invalid. It led to the subordination of DPSPs over FRs. However, FRs conferred by Articles 14 and 19 were accepted as subordinate to the DPSPs specified under Article 39(b) and (c).
- The present position is that the FRs enjoy supremacy over DPSPs. However, Parliament can amend the FRs for implementing the DPSP, so long as the amendment doesn't destroy of the basic feature of the constitution.
- **Maneka Gandhi case, 1978** - It deals with rights guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution. Prior to this, there was 'procedure prescribed by law' which was replaced by 'due process of law' with respect to article 21 of the Constitution.
- **IR Coelho case in 2007**—popularly known as the Ninth Schedule case—the Supreme Court took this further and argued that if the purpose of inserting a law into the Ninth Schedule was to undo a judgment of the Supreme Court, this could be examined by the courts. Also, the Supreme Court held that the laws placed under IX schedule after Kesavananda Bharati's judgment (24th April 1973) cannot be exempt from Judicial review.

Q 15.D

- The state has been defined in a wider sense so as to include all its agencies. It is the actions of these agencies that can be challenged in the courts as violating the Fundamental Rights.
- According to the Supreme Court, even a private body or an agency working as an instrument of the State falls within the meaning of the 'State' under Article 12.
- DMRC has equal equity participation from GOI and GNCTD.
- RBI, UID Authority are statutory bodies.
- NITI Aayog performs important public functions like recommending the poverty line.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 16.D

- **Recently, a giant fish-breeding colony has been discovered in the Weddell Sea of the Antarctica region.** A breeding colony of about 60 million icefish nest has been found recently by researchers in Antarctica's southern Weddell Sea which is the largest icefish breeding colony on record. The researchers observed that the colony occupied an unusually warm patch of deep water, with temperatures up to about

35 degrees Fahrenheit which is practically warmer compared to other Antarctic waters. The warm deep currents guide the fish to the grounds.

- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 17.B

- The Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) is the main agency for preventing corruption in the Central government. **It was established in 1964 by an executive resolution of the Central government.** Its establishment was recommended by the Santhanam Committee on Prevention of Corruption (1962–64). Thus, originally the CVC was neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body. Later, in 2003, the Parliament enacted a law conferring statutory status on the CVC. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The CVC is a multi-member body consisting of a Central Vigilance Commissioner (chairperson) and not more than two vigilance commissioners. **They are appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal** on the recommendation of a three-member committee consisting of the prime minister as its head, the Union minister of home affairs and the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha. They hold office for a term of four years or until they attain the age of sixty five years, whichever is earlier. After their tenure, they are not eligible for further employment under the Central or a state government. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 18.C

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The purpose of Article 32 is to provide a guaranteed, effective, expeditious, inexpensive and summary remedy for the protection of the fundamental rights. Only the Fundamental Rights guaranteed by the Constitution can be enforced under Article 32 and not any other right like non-fundamental constitutional rights, statutory rights, customary rights and so on. In other words, the Supreme Court, under Article 32, cannot determine a question that does not involve Fundamental Rights. Article 32 cannot be invoked simply to determine the constitutionality of an executive order or a legislation unless it directly infringes any of the fundamental rights.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** In case of the enforcement of Fundamental Rights, the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court is original but not exclusive. It is concurrent with the jurisdiction of the high court under Article 226.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Supreme Court has ruled that Article 32 is a basic feature of the Constitution. Hence, it cannot be abridged or taken away even by way of an amendment to the Constitution.

Q 19.D

The Union Territories in India have been created for a variety of reasons. These are mentioned below:

- **Political and administrative** consideration-Delhi and Chandigarh.
- **Cultural distinctiveness**-Puducherry, Dadra and Nagar Haveli, and Daman and Diu.
- **Strategic importance**-Andaman and the Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep.
- **Special treatment and care of the backward** and tribal people-Mizoram, Manipur, Tripura, and Arunachal Pradesh which later became states.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 20.A

- **Freedom of speech and expression is guaranteed under Article 19(1) of the Indian constitution.** It implies that every citizen has the right to express his views, opinions, belief, and convictions. The Supreme Court held that the freedom of speech and expression includes the following -:
 - Right to propagate one's views as well as views of others.
 - Freedom of press
 - Freedom of Commercial advertisements
 - Right against tapping of telephonic conversation
 - **Right to telecast**
 - **Freedom of silence**
 - **Right to know about government activities**
 - Right against the imposition of pre-censorship
 - Right to demonstration or picketing **but not right to strike**

Q 21.B

- The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights is a statutory body established by an Act of Parliament, the **Commission for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005**. The Commission works under the aegis of the Ministry of Women and Child Development. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) emphasizes the principle of universality and inviolability of child rights and recognizes the tone of urgency in all the child-related policies of the country. For the Commission, the protection of all **children in the 0 to 18 years age group** is of equal importance.
- The Commission shall perform the following functions, namely:
 - Examine and review the safeguards provided by any law for the protection of child rights and recommend measures for their effective implementation.
 - Present to the central government, reports upon working of those safeguards;
 - Inquire into violation of child rights
 - Examine all factors that inhibit the enjoyment of rights of children affected by terrorism, communal violence, riots,
 - Look into matters relating to children in need of special care and protection etc.
- **The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) has been designated as the agency to monitor provisions of the Right to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act.** Under the Act, NCPCR can investigate complaints and have the powers of a civil court in trying cases. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 22.C

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Student learning assessment (PARAKH) will conduct assessment of students and faculty members of higher education institutes and schools.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is launched by the All India Council for Technological Education (AICTE). AICTE is the statutory body and national level apex advisory body to conduct a survey on the facilities available for technical education and to promote development in the country in a coordinated and integrated manner.

Q 23.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Indian liberalism is different from classical or western liberalism. Classical liberalism is more concerned with individual freedom. While in India, an individual identifies himself with the community to which he/she belongs. So Indian liberalism gives primacy to the rights of the individuals over the demands of social justice and community values.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The reservation to deprived classes to meet their demands for social justice signifies the idea of Indian liberalism.

Q 24.C

- The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) of India is a Statutory public body constituted under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993.
- The various human rights issues taken up by the Commission are as follows :
 - Abolition of **Bonded Labour**
 - Issues Concerning **Right to Food**
 - Protocols to the Convention on the Rights of the Child
 - Abolition of **Child Labour**
 - **Trafficking** in Women and Children
 - **Maternal Anemia** and Human Rights
 - Combating **Sexual Harassment of Women** at the Work Place
 - Abolition of **Manual Scavenging**
 - **Dalits issues** including Atrocities perpetrated on them
 - Problems faced by **Denotified and Nomadic Tribes**.
 - Rights of the **Disabled Persons**
 - Issues related to **Right to Health**.
 - Rights of persons affected by **HIV / AIDS**
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 25.B

- **World Employment and Social Outlook** is the flagship report of **International Labour Organisation (ILO)**. World Employment and Social Outlook: Trends 2022 warns of a slow and uncertain recovery, as

the pandemic continues to have a significant impact on global labour markets. It examines the impacts of the crisis on global and regional trends in employment, unemployment and labour force participation, as well as on job quality, informal employment and working poverty. It also offers an extensive analysis of trends in temporary employment both before and during the COVID-19 crisis. This year's report provides a comprehensive assessment of how the labour market recovery has unfolded across the world in response to different country measures to tackle the pandemic. It analyses global patterns, regional differences and outcomes across economic sectors and groups of workers. It also presents projections for the expected labour market recovery.

- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 26.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The conditions of service and tenure of office of the election commissioners and the regional commissioners shall be determined by the President. Under Article 324 of the Constitution of India, the Election Commission of India is vested with the power of superintendence, direction, and control of conducting the elections to the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** In case of difference of opinion amongst the Chief election commissioner and/or two other election commissioners, the matter is decided by the Commission by the majority.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** He cannot be removed from his office except in the same manner and on the same grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court. In other words, he can be removed by the president on the basis of a resolution passed to that effect by both the Houses of Parliament with the special majority, either on the ground of proved misbehavior or incapacity. Thus, he does not hold his office till the pleasure of the president, though he is appointed by him.

Q 27.C

- President's rule has no effect on Fundamental Rights whereas National Emergency and Martial Rule have. When a National Emergency is declared, the Fundamental Rights under Article 19 are automatically suspended and this suspension continues till the end of the emergency.

Q 28.A

Constitution Amendment	Directive Principles added/changed
42nd, 1976	• To secure opportunities for healthy development of children (Article 39) • To promote equal justice and to provide free legal aid to the poor (Article 39 A) • To take steps to secure the participation of workers in the management of industries (Article 43 A) • To secure opportunities for healthy development of children (Article 39) To protect and improve the environment and to safeguard forests and wild life (Article 48 A).
44th, 1978	• The State shall, in particular, strive to minimize the inequalities in income, and endeavor to eliminate inequalities in status, facilities and opportunities, not only amongst individuals but also amongst groups of people residing in different areas or engaged in different vocations (Article 38(2))
97th, 2011	• The State shall endeavour to promote voluntary formation, autonomous functioning, democratic control and professional management of co-operative societies. (Article 43-B)
86th, 2002	• The State shall endeavour to provide early childhood care and education for all children until they complete the age of six years. (The subject of article 45 changed)

Q 29.B

- The **doctrine of Pleasure of President** has been borrowed from the British. In England, The doctrine of pleasure means that the Crown has the power to terminate the services of a civil servant at any time they want without giving any notice of termination to the servant. Thus the civil servants work at the pleasure of the Crown which can remove them at any time. This doctrine is based on the **concept of public policy** and whenever the Crown feels that a civil servant should be removed from his office because keeping him will be against public policy, the Crown can remove such servant.
- India has adopted this provision though there exist some modifications in case of the civil servants. (Article 310)

- The **term of office of the AG is not fixed** by the Constitution. Further, the Constitution does not contain the procedure and grounds for his removal. He holds office during the pleasure of the president.
- **CAG holds office for a period of six years or up to the age of 65 years**, whichever is earlier. He can resign any time from his office by addressing the resignation letter to the president. He can also be removed by the president on **same grounds and in the same manner as a judge of the Supreme Court**. In other words, he can be removed by the president on the basis of a resolution passed to that effect by both the Houses of Parliament with a special majority, either on the ground of proved misbehavior or incapacity. Thus, he does not hold his office until the pleasure of the president, though he is appointed by him.
- The President can **remove the chairman or any other member of UPSC from the office under the following circumstances**:
 - If he is adjudged an insolvent (that is, has gone bankrupt)
 - If he engages, during his term of office, in any paid employment outside the duties of his office; or
 - If he is, in the opinion of the president, unfit to continue in office by reason of infirmity of mind or body.
 - In addition to these, the President can also remove the chairman or any other member of UPSC for misbehavior. However, in this case, the president has to refer the matter to the Supreme Court for an inquiry. If the Supreme Court, after the inquiry, upholds the cause of removal and advises so, the President can remove the chairman or a member. Under the provisions of the Constitution, the advice tendered by the Supreme Court in this regard is binding on the President. Thus, Members/Chairman do not hold his office until the pleasure of the president, though they are appointed by him.
- The **chief election commissioner is provided with the security of tenure**. He cannot be removed from his office except in the same manner and on the same **grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court**. In other words, he can be removed by the President on the basis of a resolution passed to that effect by both the Houses of Parliament with a special majority, either on the ground of proved misbehavior or incapacity. Thus, he does not hold his office until the pleasure of the President, though he is appointed by him.

Q 30.A

- **What are Padma awards?**
 - They are the **highest civilian honor of India after the Bharat Ratna**.
 - **Instituted in 1954** along with Bharat Ratna.
 - The awards are given in **three categories**: Padma Vibhushan (for exceptional and distinguished service), Padma Bhushan (distinguished service of higher-order), and Padma Shri (distinguished service).
 - The award seeks to recognize achievements in all fields of activities or disciplines where an element of public service is involved.
- **Limitations and exceptions**:
 - The awardees **do not get any cash reward** but a certificate signed by the President apart from a medallion which they can wear at public and government functions.
 - The awards are, however, not a conferment of title, and the awardees are expected to not use them as prefixes or suffixes to their names.
 - A Padma awardee **can be given a higher award only after five years of the conferment of the earlier award. Hence statement 1 is correct**.
 - **Not more than 120 awards can be given in a year** but this does not include posthumous awards or awards given to NRIs and foreigners.
- **Eligibility**:
 - All persons without distinction of race, occupation, position, or sex are eligible for these awards. However, government servants including those working with PSUs, except doctors and scientists, are not eligible for these awards.
 - The award is given for “special services” and not just for “long service”. “It should not be merely excellence in a particular field, but the criteria have to be ‘excellence plus’.
- **Who nominates the awardees?**
 - Any citizen of India can nominate a potential recipient.
 - One can even nominate one’s own self.
 - All nominations are to be done online where a form is to be filled along with details of the person or the organization being nominated.
 - An 800-word essay detailing the work done by the potential awardee is also to be submitted for the nomination to be considered.

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- **Who selects the awardees?**
 - All nominations received for Padma awards are placed before the Padma Awards Committee, which is constituted by the Prime Minister every year.
 - **The Padma Awards Committee is headed by the Cabinet Secretary** and includes Home Secretary, Secretary to the President, and four to six eminent persons as members. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - The recommendations of the committee are submitted to the Prime Minister and the President of India for approval.
- **Is the recipient's consent sought?**
 - There is **no provision for seeking a written or formal consent of the recipient before the announcement of the award.** However, before the announcement, every recipient receives a call from the Ministry of Home Affairs informing him or her about the selection. In case the recipient expresses a desire to be excluded from the award list, the name is removed. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 31.A

- The Constitution of India has borrowed most of its provisions from the constitutions of various other countries as well as from the Government of India Act of 1935. Dr B R Ambedkar proudly acclaimed that the Constitution of India has been framed after 'ransacking all the known Constitutions of the World'.
- The structural part of the Constitution is, to a large extent, derived from the Government of India Act of 1935. The philosophical part of the Constitution (**the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles of State Policy**) **derive their inspiration from the American and Irish Constitutions respectively.** The **political part of the Constitution (the principle of Cabinet Government and the relations between the executive and the legislature) have been largely drawn from the British Constitution.**
- The other provisions of the Constitution have been drawn from the constitutions of Canada, Australia, Germany, USSR (now Russia), France, South Africa, Japan, and so on.
- However, the criticism that the Indian Constitution is a 'borrowed Constitution', a 'patchwork' and contains nothing new and original is unfair and illogical. This is because, the framers of the Constitution made necessary modifications in the features borrowed from other constitutions for their suitability to the Indian conditions, at the same time avoiding their faults.

Q 32.A

- **Statement 1 is correct:** State Election Commissions is entrusted to conduct elections to Panchayats through 73rd and urban local bodies through 74th Constitutional amendment acts.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The functions of delimitation, reservation and rotation of Panchayats seats is vested in State Election Commission. As per the recommendations of National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution (NCRWC), the functions of delimitation, reservation and rotation of seats should be vested in a Delimitation Commission and not in the State Election Commission.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** At present, there is no clear-cut provision regarding the submission of reports by State Election Commission. NCRWC also recommended that the State Election Commission should submit its annual or special reports to the Election Commission of India and to the Governor.

Q 33.C

- National Commission for Minorities falls under the Minorities Ministry of Minority Affairs.
- National Commission for Women falls under the Ministry of Women and Child Development.
- National Commission for STs falls under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs.
- **Hence, only pairs 2 and 3 are correctly matched.**

Q 34.C

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Article 280 of the Constitution of India provides for a Finance Commission. It is a quasi judicial body. The Finance Commission shall have **all powers of civil court under Code of Civil Procedure (1908) in matters of summoning & enforcing attendance and requisitioning any public record from any court of office.** Also Finance Commission shall be deemed to be a civil court for purposes of sections 480 and 482 of the CrPC provided under Finance Commission Act
- It is constituted by the President of India every fifth year or at such earlier time as he considers necessary.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Finance Commission consists of a chairman and four other members to be appointed by the President. They hold office for such period as specified by the President in his order.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** They are eligible for reappointment.

Q 35.A

- **What is a Scheduled Bank?**
 - Scheduled Banks in India refer to those banks which have been included in the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.
 - Every Scheduled bank enjoys two types of principal facilities: It becomes **eligible for debts/loans at the bank rate from the RBI**; and, it automatically acquires the **membership of clearinghouse**. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.
- **What are Payments bank?**
 - Payment banks were established to promote financial inclusion by offering; 'modest savings accounts and payments/remittance services to migratory labor workforce, low-income households, small enterprises, other unorganized sector entities, and other users.'
 - These banks can accept a restricted deposit, which is **now capped at Rs 200,000 per person** but could be raised in the future. Hence, **statement 3 is not correct**.
 - These banks are unable to provide loans or credit cards. Banks of this type **can handle both current and savings accounts**.
 - Payments banks **can provide ATM and debit cards**, as well as online and mobile banking. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.

Q 36.D

- The Constitution of India was adopted on 26th November 1949 and formally started in January 1950. Since then, the constitution continues to function as the framework in which the government of our country operates.
- In the actual working of the Constitution, there has been enough flexibility of interpretations. **Both political practice and judicial rulings have shown maturity and flexibility in implementing the Constitution. Changes have regularly been made in order to reflect the contemporary aspects of political philosophy and the aspirations of society.** The Judiciary has contributed by interpreting various provisions concerning the right to education, the right to life and liberty, and the right to form and manage minority educational institutions. Political parties, political leaders, the government, and the Parliament, accepted the idea of inviolable basic structure introduced in the Kesavananda case. Even when there was talk about 'review' of the Constitution, it was understood that the exercise could not cross the limits set by the theory of the basic structure.
- **The basic framework of the Constitution continues to suit our country.** The provisions of the constitution reflect efforts to tackle the problems that the society was facing at the time of the making of the constitution. At the same time, the constitution was envisioned to be a document that provides the framework of the government for the future as well. Therefore, the constitution allows for a response to the challenges that may arise in the future.
- **The makers of the Constitution placed the Constitution above ordinary law and expected that future generations will respect this document. At the same time, they recognized that in the future, it may require modifications.** They understood that Constitution must be amended if required but it must be protected from unnecessary and frequent changes as well.
- **The constitution is a sacred document but it may require changes from time to time as well.** Therefore, the Constitution is not a static document or not the final word about everything and is not unalterable.

Q 37.B

- The **Comptroller & Auditor General of India** is provided with the security of tenure. He can be removed by the President only in accordance with the procedure mentioned in the Constitution. Thus, he does not hold his office till the pleasure of the president, though he is appointed by him. Also, **he is not eligible for further office, either under the Government of India or of any state, after he ceases to hold his office**. Hence, **option (b) is correct**.
- The **Attorney General is not a full-time counsel for the Government**. He does not fall in the category of government servants. Further, **he is not debarred from private legal practice**.
- The chairman of UPSC (on ceasing to hold office) is not eligible for further employment in the Government of India or a state. **A member of UPSC (on ceasing to hold office) is eligible for appointment as the chairman of UPSC or a State Public Service Commission (SPSC), but not for any other employment in the Government of India or a state.**

Q 38.D

- The National Commission for Scheduled Tribes was established under Article 338-A of the Constitution with the objective of monitoring the safeguards provided for STs under the Constitution or other laws. The functions of the National Commission for STs include:
 - To inquire into specific complaints with respect to the deprivation of rights and safeguards of the STs.
 - To suggest measures to be taken over conferring ownership rights in respect of minor forest produce to STs living in forest areas.
 - To suggest measures to be taken to ensure full implementation of the Provisions of Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996.
- **Hence, all the statements are correct.**

Q 39.C

- **Right against Exploitation includes Article 23 and 24 of the Constitution.**
- Article 23 prohibits traffic in human beings, begar (forced labour) and other similar forms of forced labour.
- Article 24 prohibits the employment of children below the age of 14 years in any factory, mine or other hazardous activities like construction work or railway.
- **Protection against arrest and detention is provided under Article 22 and is under Right to Freedom (Art.19-22)**

Q 40.A

- **Statement 1 is correct:** by this act, the constituent assembly made a fully sovereign body. This act also empowered the assembly to abrogate or alter any law made by the British in relation to India
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The act abolished the office of the viceroy and provided for each dominion, a Governor-General.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** This act ended British Rule in India and declared India as an independent and sovereign state from August 15, 1947. It proclaimed the lapse of British paramountcy over Indian Princely states and granted freedom to princely states to either to join two independent states (Pakistan or India) or remain independent.

Q 41.C

- **If any foreign territory becomes a part of India, the Government of India specifies the persons who among the people of the territory shall be the citizens of India.** Such persons become the citizens of India from the notified date. For example, when Pondicherry became a part of India, the Government of India issued the Citizenship (Pondicherry) Order, 1962, under the Citizenship Act, 1955.

Q 42.B

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Article 17 states that "Untouchability" is abolished and its practice in any form is forbidden.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Untouchability has not been defined by the constitution but various court judgments have expanded its meaning.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** It is available against both the state and private individuals. Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 contains many provisions for this.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Article 17 only states that the enforcement of any disability arising out of "Untouchability" shall be an offense punishable in accordance with the law. Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 contains the detailed provisions for this.

Q 43.A

- Scientists have discovered recently evolved regions that codes for proteins in DNA outside our genes associated with schizophrenia and bipolar disorder that can have profound impact on people's lives. **These DNA outside of the regions conventionally defined as genes are known as dark genome.** They are genes/proteins for which there is minimal knowledge on biological function and allied to this limited tools for their analysis such as antibodies. Thus it adversely affects the precision medicine initiative.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 44.D

- A State Public Service Commission consists of a chairman and other members appointed by the governor of the state. The Constitution does not specify the strength of the Commission but has left the matter to the discretion of the Governor. Further, no qualifications are prescribed for the commission's membership

except that one-half of the members of the commission should be such persons who have held office for at least ten years either under the government of India or under the Government of a state. The Constitution also authorizes the governor to determine the conditions of service of the chairman and members of the Commission. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**

- Although the chairman and members of an SPSC are appointed by the governor, they **can be removed only by the President (and not by the governor)**. The President can remove them on the same grounds and in the same manner as he can remove a chairman or a member of the UPSC. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 45.C

- Both the Dhar commission and JVP committee rejected language as the basis for the reorganization of states. Fazl Ali's commission broadly accepted language as the criteria for the reorganization of states, however, it rejected one- language - state policy.
- Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 46.B

- The Protection of Human Rights Act of 1993 provides for the creation of the National Human Rights Commission and State Human Rights Commission at the state level.
- A State Human Rights Commission can inquire into violation of human rights **only in respect of subjects** mentioned in the **State List** and the **Concurrent List** of the Constitution.
- However, if any such case is already being inquired into by the National Human Rights Commission or any other Statutory Commission, then the State Human Rights Commission does not inquire into that case.
- The chairperson and members of SHRC are **appointed by the Governor**. Whereas, in the case of NHRC, **they are appointed by the President of India. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Although the chairperson and members of an SHRC are appointed by the governor, **they can be removed only by the President. Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 47.A

- The Supreme Court has held that a religious denomination must satisfy three conditions:
- It should be a collection of individuals who have a system of beliefs (doctrines), which they regard as conducive to their spiritual well-being.
- It should have a common organization
- It should be designated by a distinctive name.
- Hence only options 1, 2, and 3 are correct.**

Q 48.A

- Option 1 is one of the fundamental duties mentioned in Part IV-A of the Indian constitution.
- Option 2 is a part of Directive Principles of State Policy.
- Swaran Singh Committee recommended duty to pay taxes should be included in the fundamental duties but it was not accepted. Hence, option 3 is not a fundamental duty.
- Casting vote is also not included in the fundamental duties so option 4 is also not correct.
- Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 49.D

- The doctrine of Basic structure of the Constitution was laid down by the Supreme Court in the case of Kesavananda Bharati v/s State of Kerala (1973). Based on various judgements of the Court, the following are some of the elements included in the Basic structure: Supremacy of the Constitution; **Secular character of the Constitution**; Sovereign, democratic and republic nature of polity; **Separation of powers between the legislature, judiciary and executive**; Unity and Integrity of the nation; Welfare state; Rule of Law; Parliamentary system; Effective access to justice; **Principle of reasonableness** etc
- Socialist state is not included in the Basic structure.**

Q 50.A

- Pressure groups are organizations that attempt to influence government policies. But unlike political parties, pressure groups do not aim to directly control or share political power. These organizations are formed when people with common occupations, interests, aspirations, or opinions come together in order to achieve a common objective.

- We often hear the word people's movement to describe many forms of collective action: Narmada Bachao Andolan, Movement for Right to Information, Anti-liquor Movement, Women's Movement, Environmental Movement.
- **Like an interest group, a movement also attempts to influence politics rather than directly take part in electoral competition. But unlike the interest groups, movements have a loose organization. Their decision-making is more informal and flexible. They depend much more on spontaneous mass participation than an interest group.**

Q 51.D

- The procedure for the amendment of the Constitution as laid down in Article 368 is as follows:
 - An amendment of the Constitution can be initiated only by the introduction of a bill for the purpose in either House of Parliament and not in the state legislatures.
 - The bill can be introduced either by a minister or by a private member and does not require prior permission of the president. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
 - The bill must be passed in each House by a special majority, that is, a majority (that is, more than 50 per cent) of the total membership of the House and a majority of two-thirds of the members of the House present and voting. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - Each House must pass the bill separately. In case of a disagreement between the two Houses, there is no provision for holding a joint sitting of the two Houses for the purpose of deliberation and passage of the bill.
 - If the bill seeks to amend the federal provisions of the Constitution, it must also be ratified by the legislatures of at least half of the states by a simple majority, that is, a majority of the members of the House present and voting.
 - After duly passed by both the Houses of Parliament and ratified by the state legislatures, where necessary, the bill is presented to the president for assent.
 - The President must give his assent to the bill. He can neither withhold his assent to the bill nor return the bill for reconsideration of the Parliament.

Q 52.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** the constitution derives its authority from the people of India not from the constituent assembly, this is mentioned in the preamble part of the constitution.
- **Statement 2 is not correct** - the American constitution was the first to begin with a Preamble. Many countries, including India, followed the practice.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** In the Keshavananda Bharti case, SC has held that preamble is a part of the Constitution. And if there is any lack of clarity in the constitution, the judiciary turns to the Preamble in its interpretation of the relevant provisions.

Q 53.C

- **Article 359 authorises the President to suspend the right to move any court for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights during a National Emergency. This means that under Article 359, the Fundamental Rights as such are not suspended, but only their enforcement.** The said rights are theoretically alive but the right to seek remedy is suspended. **The suspension of enforcement relates to only those Fundamental Rights that are specified in the Presidential Order.** Further, the suspension could be for the period during the operation of emergency or for a shorter period as mentioned in the order, and the suspension order may extend to the whole or any part of the country. It should be laid before each House of Parliament for approval. **Hence, only option (c) is correct.**
- The **44th Amendment Act of 1978 restricted the scope of Article 359** in two ways. Firstly, the President cannot suspend the right to move the Court for the enforcement of fundamental rights guaranteed by Articles 20 to 21. Secondly, only those laws which are related with the emergency are protected from being challenged and not other laws and the executive action taken only under such a law, is protected.
- Article 359 operates in case of both when National Emergency is declared on grounds of war or external aggression as well as on the ground of armed rebellion.
- **Article 359 may extend to the entire country or a part of it.**

Q 54.B

- Recently, doctors transplanted a pig heart into a patient in a last-ditch effort to save his life which has marked the step towards the decades-long quest of using animal organs for life-saving transplants. **Xenotransplantation is a term associated with transplantation, implantation, or infusion of cells,**

tissues or organs among different species. It is defined by the US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) as "any procedure that involves the transplantation, implantation or infusion into a human recipient of either (a) live cells, tissues, or organs from a nonhuman animal source, or (b) human body fluids, cells, tissues or organs that have had ex vivo contact with live nonhuman animal cells, tissues or organs. The demand for human cells, tissues and organs for clinical transplantation continues to exceed the supply. The limited availability of human allografts, coupled with recent scientific and biotechnical advances, has prompted the renewed development of investigational therapeutic approaches that use xenotransplantation products in human recipients.

- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 55.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct.** Martial law has not been defined anywhere in the Constitution. It is implicit. Also, there is no specific or express provision in the Constitution that authorizes the executive to declare Martial Law. However, Article 34 provides for the restrictions on fundamental rights while Martial Law is in force in any area.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Both Martial Law and National Emergency can be imposed in some specific area. However, the scope of National emergency is much more. It can be imposed in the whole country as well.

Q 56.A

- Recently, the Supreme Court on Friday turned down the Union government's plea to do away with the requirement of collecting quantifiable data by the Centre and states to determine the representation of people belonging to Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs) while implementing reservation in promotion.
- **State is obligated to collect quantifiable data as per the court's judgment in M Nagaraj (2006) and Jarnail Singh (2018). Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- In 2006, a Constitution bench's ruling in the M Nagaraj case made it incumbent upon the state to collect quantifiable data showing the inadequacy of representation of a section of people in public employment in addition to maintaining overall administrative efficiency.
- The aspect of quantifiable data was endorsed by another Constitution bench by its 2018 ruling in the Jarnail Singh case which also mandated the exclusion of the "creamy layer" before providing for reservation in promotions.
- The collection of data has to be for each category of posts for the entire service.
- **It added that assessment on the inadequacy of representation of the reserved categories in promotional posts should be left to the states. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 57.B

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Indian Councils Act of 1861 empowered Viceroy to issue ordinances without the concurrence of the legislative council, during an emergency. The life of such an ordinance was 6 months.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** It made a beginning of representative institutions by associating Indians with the law-making process. It thus provided that the viceroy should nominate some Indians as non-official members of his expanded council. In 1862, Lord Canning, the then viceroy, nominated three Indians to his legislative council-the Raja of Benaras, the Maharaja of Patiala, and Sir Dinkar Rao.
- **Statement 3 is not correct. The office was created under the provisions of the Act of 1858 (Act for Good Governance of India)**

Q 58.A

- 'Territory of India' is a wider expression than the 'Union of India' because the latter **includes only states** while the former includes not only the states but also union territories and territories that may be acquired by the Government of India at any future time.

Q 59.C

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** In the parliamentary form of the government, there will not be a watertight separation of the powers. Here the executive will be part of the legislature.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is the most defining feature of the parliamentary form of the government, where executive is answerable to the legislature, unlike the presidential form of the government, where the executive is not answerable to the legislature.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Parliamentary form of government defines the governing mechanism of a state. Division of powers is nothing to do with the parliamentary form of government because division of powers is more to do with the decentralization and autonomy to the states rather than way of defining the governing mechanism itself.

Q 60.A

- The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 abolished the right to property as a Fundamental Right by repealing Article 19(1)(f) and Article 31 from Part III. Instead, the Act inserted a new Article 300A in Part XII under the heading 'Right to Property'. It provides that no person shall be deprived of his property except by authority of law.
- **Thus, the Right to property now no longer remains a fundamental right.** It is not a part of the basic structure of the Constitution. The right to property as a legal right (as distinct from the Fundamental Rights) has the following implications:
 - **It can be regulated i.e., curtailed, abridged or modified without constitutional amendment by an ordinary law of the Parliament.**
 - It protects the private property against executive action but not against legislative action.
 - **In case of violation, the aggrieved person cannot directly move the Supreme Court under Article 32 (right to constitutional remedies including writs) for its enforcement. He can move the High Court under Article 226. Hence only statement 3 is not correct.**
 - No guaranteed right to compensation in case of acquisition or requisition of private property by the state.

Q 61.A

- The following were included in the Objectives Resolution as passed by the Constituent Assembly- India is an independent, sovereign, republic; All powers and authority of independent India and its constitution shall flow from the people.
- Summary of Objectives resolution-
 - India is an independent, sovereign, republic;
 - India shall be a Union of erstwhile British Indian territories, Indian States, and other parts outside British India and Indian States as are willing to be a part of the Union;
 - Territories forming the Union shall be autonomous units and exercise all powers and functions of the Government and administration, except those assigned to or vested in the Union;
 - **All powers and authority of sovereign and independent India and its constitution shall flow from the people;**
 - All people of India shall be guaranteed and secured social, economic and political justice; equality of status and opportunities and equality before law; and fundamental freedoms - of speech, expression, belief, faith, worship, vocation, association and action - subject to law and public morality;
 - **The minorities, backward and tribal areas, depressed and other backward classes shall be provided adequate safeguards;**
 - The territorial integrity of the Republic and its sovereign rights on land, sea and air shall be maintained according to justice and law of civilized nations;
 - **The land would make full and willing contribution to the promotion of world peace and welfare of mankind.**

Q 62.C

- **Bhunglota is a creeper (plants that grows close to ground and have horizontal growth) that in combination with the pith of the roots of a jackfruit tree yields a saffron dye.** It is traditionally used in giving colour to the robes of the Buddhist monks. The people of villages in the vicinity converged to form Chala Village Sanctuary Conservation Society that is a 173-hectare reserve forest under the Sivasagar Forest Division, Assam. The Buddhist in the area have raised the concerns regarding the near-extinction of bhunglota and called a movement for conserving the adjoining Chala Reserve Forest to preserve the bhunglota. The Chala Reserve Forest is about 100 metres above sea level and it houses a few orchids that are usually found in higher altitudes.
- **Hence option (c) is the answer.**

Q 63.C

- The members from the princely states were nominated and members from that of British Provinces were elected indirectly from the Provincial Legislative Assemblies, but not directly by the people.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 64.C

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Indian constitution is a sacred document but not a static one. It allows changes if the demand is made by society. After independence, several amendments/provisions and laws were made as the needs of the society.

- **Statement 2 is correct.** Ever since the constitution came into being, the political class and the judiciary subjected it to multiple interpretations. Judicial pronouncements/judgments have led to the establishment of several doctrines which was not mentioned in the original constitution. Eg - Basic Structure Doctrine.

Q 65.C

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** It is concerned with the recruitment to the all-India services and Central services—group A and group B and advises the government, when consulted, on promotion and disciplinary matters. It is not concerned with the classification of services, pay and service conditions, cadre management, training, and so on which is managed by the Department of Personnel and Training of government of India.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The UPSC presents, annually, to the president a report on its performance. The President places this report before both the Houses of Parliament, along with a memorandum explaining the cases where the advice of the Commission was not accepted and the reasons for such non-acceptance.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The additional functions relating to the services of the Union can be conferred on UPSC by the Parliament. It can also place the personnel system of any authority, corporate body or public institution within the jurisdiction of the UPSC. Hence the jurisdiction of UPSC can be extended by an Act made by the Parliament.

Q 66.B

- The Preamble of the Constitution defines the Indian Republic as **Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, and Democratic**. Of these, Sovereign and Democratic were part of the Preamble adopted by the Constituent Assembly.
- **Socialists and Secular were added to the Preamble by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976.** Also, the word 'integrity' was added by the same act.

Q 67.C

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The Constitution makes a provision for the establishment of a Joint State Public Service Commission (JSPSC) for two or more states. While the UPSC and the SPSC are created directly by the Constitution, a JSPSC can be created by an act of Parliament on the request of the state legislatures concerned.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The chairman and members of a JSPSC are appointed by the president. They hold office for a term of six years or until they attain the age of 62 years, whichever is earlier.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** A JPSC presents its annual performance report to each of the concerned state governors. Each governor places the report before the state legislature.

Q 68.B

- In addition to the Attorney General, there are other law officers of the Government of India. They are the Solicitor General of India and additional Solicitor General of India. **They assist the Attorney General in the fulfillment of his official responsibilities.** It should be noted here that only the office of the Attorney General is created by the Constitution. In other words, **Article 76 does not mention about the Solicitor General and additional Solicitor General.**

Q 69.B

- It was in 1934 that the idea of a Constituent Assembly for India was put forward for the first time by **M. N. Roy**, a pioneer of communist movement in India and an advocate of radical democracy. In 1935, the Indian National Congress (INC), for the first time, officially demanded a Constituent Assembly to frame the Constitution of India. In 1938, Jawaharlal Nehru, on behalf the INC declared that 'the Constitution of free India must be framed, without outside interference, by a Constituent Assembly elected on the basis of adult franchise'.

Q 70.C

- Recently, Russia has stationed about 100,000 troops near its border with Ukraine.
- The North Atlantic Treaty Organization also called the North Atlantic Alliance, is an intergovernmental military alliance between 27 European countries, 2 North American countries, and 1 Eurasian country.
- The organization implements the North Atlantic Treaty that was signed on 4 April 1949.
- Its headquarters is located in Brussels, Belgium. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- **NATO is committed to the principle that an attack against one or several of its members is considered as an attack against all. Hence statement 1 is correct**

- This is the principle of collective defense, which is enshrined in Article 5 of the Washington Treaty.
- So far, Article 5 has been invoked once - in response to the 9/11 terrorist attacks in the United States in 2001.

Q 71.D

- **Both the statements are not correct.**
- During an emergency, the Central Government becomes all-powerful and the states go into total control of the center. It converts the federal structure into a unitary one without a formal amendment of the Constitution. **This kind of transformation of the political system from federal (during normal times) to unitary (during an emergency) is not borrowed from any Constitution of the world.**
- **The feature of suspension of Fundamental Rights during Emergency has been borrowed from the Weimar Constitution of Germany and hence, not a unique feature of the Indian Constitution.**

Q 72.A

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Any bill contemplating the changes with regard to the reorganization of states can be introduced in the parliament only with the prior recommendation of the President.
- **Statement 2 is not correct.** Under article 3 of the Constitution, the parliament's power to diminish the areas of a state does not include the power to cede Indian territory to a foreign state. Indian territory can be ceded to a foreign state only by amending the Constitution under Article 368.
- **Statement 3 is not correct.** Any bill aiming to reorganize the states shall be passed in the parliament by a simple majority.

Q 73.C

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Constitution (Article 165) has provided for the office of the Advocate General for the states. He is the highest law officer in the state. The advocate general is appointed by the governor.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Eligibility conditions for Advocate General does not include minimum age limits. He must be a person who is qualified to be appointed a judge of a high court. In other words, he must be a citizen of India and must have held a judicial office for ten years or been an advocate of a high court for ten years.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The remuneration of the Advocate General is not fixed by the Constitution. He receives such remuneration as the Governor may determine.

Q 74.A

- The writ of Habeas Corpus can be issued against private individuals as well as a public authority. While other writs like Mandamus, Prohibition, and Certiorari can be issued only against public authorities.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 75.A

- Article 33 empowers the Parliament to restrict or abrogate the fundamental rights of the members of armed forces, para-military forces, police forces, intelligence agencies, and analogous forces. The objective of this provision is to ensure the proper discharge of their duties and the maintenance of discipline among them. The power to make laws under Article 33 is conferred only on Parliament and not on state legislatures. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Any such law made by Parliament cannot be challenged in any court on the ground of contravention of any of the fundamental rights. **Hence statement 2 is correct.** Accordingly, the Parliament has enacted the Army Act (1950), the Navy Act (1950), the Air Force Act (1950), the Police Forces (Restriction of Rights) Act, 1966, the Border Security Force Act and so on. These impose restrictions on their freedom of speech, right to form associations, right to be members of trade unions or political associations, right to communicate with the press, right to attend public meetings or demonstrations, etc.
- The expression 'members of the armed forces' also covers such employees of the armed forces as barbers, carpenters, mechanics, cooks, chowkidars, bootmakers, tailors who are non-combatants. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 76.A

- The Constitution of India (Article 148) provides for an independent office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG). **He is the head of the Indian Audit and Accounts Department.** He is the guardian of the public purse and controls the entire financial system of the country at both the levels—the Centre and the state. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- He holds office for a period of six years or upto the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- No minister can represent the CAG in Parliament (both Houses) and no minister can be called upon to take any responsibility for any actions done by him. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 77.C

- Based on the report of the Sarkaria Commission on Centre–State Relations (1988), the Supreme Court in Bommai case (1994) enlisted the situations where the exercise of power under Article 356 could be proper or improper.
- The imposition of President’s Rule in a state would be proper in the following situations:
 - Where after general elections to the assembly, no party secures a majority, that is, ‘Hung Assembly’.
 - Where the party having a majority in the assembly declines to form a ministry and the governor cannot find a coalition ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.
 - Where a ministry resigns after its defeat in the assembly and no other party is willing or able to form a ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.
 - **Where a constitutional direction of the Central government is disregarded by the state government.**
 - **Internal subversion where, for example, a government is deliberately acting against the Constitution and the law or is fomenting a violent revolt.**
 - Physical breakdown where the government wilfully refuses to discharge its constitutional obligations endangering the security of the state.
- The imposition of President’s Rule in a state would be improper under the following situations:
 - Where a ministry resigns or is dismissed on losing majority support in the assembly and the governor recommends imposition of President’s Rule without probing the possibility of forming an alternative ministry.
 - Where the governor makes his own assessment of the support of a ministry in the assembly and recommends imposition of President’s Rule without allowing the ministry to prove its majority on the floor of the Assembly.
 - Where the ruling party enjoying majority support in the assembly has suffered a massive defeat in the general elections to the Lok Sabha such as in 1977 and 1980.
 - Internal disturbances not amounting to internal subversion or physical breakdown
 - **Maladministration in the state or allegations of corruption against the ministry or stringent financial exigencies of the state.**
 - Where the state government is not given prior warning to rectify itself except in case of extreme urgency leading to disastrous consequences.
 - Where the power is used to sort out intra-party problems of the ruling party, or for a purpose extraneous or irrelevant to the one for which it has been conferred by the Constitution.

Q 78.D

- “There shall be a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advice the President who shall act in accordance with such advice”, was added as Art 74(1) by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act.
- The minimum age for voting was reduced to 18 years by the 61st Constitutional Amendment Act.
- “The State can make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes and citizens of Scheduled castes and Scheduled tribes”, was added as Art 15(4) by the First Constitutional Amendment Act.
- **Hence, all of the above provisions were added through Constitutional Amendments.**

Q 79.C

- An international group of astronomers has recently obtained the first clues about extremely rare giant eruptions which is known as Ultra-Long Period Magnetar (ULP) that emerged from a magnetar located 13 million light years away. **Magnetars are a type of isolated neutron stars that possess the most intense magnetic fields.** They experience violent eruptions or intense bursts in the form of transient X-ray pulses which are several orders higher than that of the Sun. Even inactive magnetars can be thousands of times more luminous than the Sun.
- **Statement 1 is correct: It is a type of slowly spinning neutron star** that has been predicted to exist theoretically. According to the scientists involved in the research, the single event released energy equivalent to what the Sun would radiate in one lakh years.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The emission is highly linearly polarized, bright, persists for 30–60 s on each occurrence and is visible across a broad frequency range. At times, the pulses comprise short-duration (<0.5 s) bursts; at others, a smoother profile is observed. These profiles evolve on timescales of hours.

Q 80.D

- The Directive Principles, although confer no legal rights and creates no legal remedies, are significant and useful in the following ways:
 - They are like an 'Instrument of Instructions' or general recommendations addressed to all authorities in the Indian Union. They remind them of the basic principles of the new social and economic order, which the Constitution aims at the building.
 - **They have served as useful beacon-lights to the courts. They have helped the courts in exercising their power of judicial review, that is, the power to determine the constitutional validity of a law.**
 - They form the dominating background to all State action, legislative or executive, and also a guide to the courts in some respects.
 - They amplify the Preamble, which solemnly resolves to secure to all citizens of India justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity.
 - They facilitate stability and continuity in domestic and foreign policies in political, economic, and social spheres in spite of the changes of the party in power.
 - **They are supplementary to the fundamental rights of the citizens. They are intended to fill in the vacuum in Part III by providing for social and economic rights.**
 - Their implementation creates a favorable atmosphere for the full and proper enjoyment of the fundamental rights of the citizens. Political democracy, without economic democracy, has no meaning.
 - **They enable the opposition to exercise influence and control over the operations of the government. The Opposition can blame the ruling party on the ground that its activities are opposed to the Directives.**
 - They serve as a crucial test for the performance of the government. The people can examine the policies and programs of the government in light of these constitutional declarations.

Q 81.D

- The Citizenship Act, 1955, prescribes three ways of losing citizenship whether acquired under the Act or prior to it under the Constitution. These are:
 - By Renunciation: Any citizen of India of full age and capacity can make a declaration renouncing his Indian citizenship. Upon the registration of that declaration, that person ceases to be a citizen of India.
 - By Termination: When an Indian citizen voluntarily acquires the citizenship of another country, his Indian citizenship automatically terminates. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - By Deprivation: It is a compulsory termination of Indian citizenship by the Central government, if:
 - ✓ the citizen has obtained citizenship by fraud. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
 - ✓ the citizen has shown disloyalty to the Constitution of India.
 - ✓ the citizen has unlawfully traded or communicated with the enemy during a war. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - ✓ the citizen has, within five years after registration or naturalization, been imprisoned in any country for two years; and
 - ✓ the citizen has been ordinarily resident out of India for seven years continuously.

Q 82.A

- Recently Delhi Assembly has passed an amendment bill to “Delhi Sikh Gurdwara Act, 1971” which recognizes the “Takht Damdama Sahib” as the fifth Takht of Sikhs.
- **What are Sikh takhts?**
 - Takht is a Persian word that means imperial throne. **Takht (Throne) is a seat of temporal authority for Sikhs.** The Sikh Takhts issue hukumnamas from time to time on issues related to the Sikh community. At present Sikhs recognize five places as takhts. **Three are in Punjab** — Akal Takht (Amritsar); Takht Keshgarh Sahib (Anandpur Sahib); Takht Damdama Sahib (Talwandi Sabo) — and the other two are Takht Patna Sahib (Bihar) and Takht Hazur Sahib (Nanded, Maharashtra). **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
 - **Akal Takht** (Throne of the Timeless One) is the **oldest of the takhts**, and considered supreme among the five. It was **set up in 1606 by Guru Hargobind**, whose succession as the sixth Guru after the execution of his father, Guru Arjan Dev, is considered a turning point in Sikh history. The Akal

Takht, a raised platform that he built in front of the causeway leading to the sanctum sanctorum of the Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple), symbolized the coming together of the temporal authority and the political sovereignty of the Sikh community (miri) with the spiritual authority (piri). It is seen as the first marker of Sikh nationalism. The Akal Takht is a five-story building today; the first storey houses the Guru Granth Sahib.

- The **other four takhts are linked to Guru Gobind Singh, the tenth Guru. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- **What is the role of takhts?**
 - Takhts are known to issue hukumnamas from time to time on issues that concern the community. Akal Takht is supreme because it is the oldest and was created by a Sikh guru himself, say Sikh historians and scholars. Any edict or order concerning the entire community is issued only from Akal Takht. Also, it is from Akal Takht that Sikhs found to be violating the Sikh doctrine and code of conduct are awarded religious punishment (declared tankhaiya) and even excommunicated, depending on the degree of violation and failure of adherence to directives of the highest temporal seat of Sikhs.
- **Who appoints the jathedars of takhts?**
 - The **three takhts in Punjab are directly controlled by the SGPC**, which appoints the jathedars for these. The two takhts outside Punjab have their own trusts and boards. There is no fixed tenure. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 83.D

- **A number of provisions in the Constitution can be amended by a simple majority of the two Houses of Parliament outside the scope of Article 368.** These provisions include **abolition or creation of legislative councils in states, Citizenship—acquisition and termination etc.**
- The majority of the **provisions in the Constitution need to be amended by a special majority of the Parliament**, that is, a majority (that is, more than 50 per cent) of the total membership of each House and a majority of two-thirds of the members of each House present and voting. The expression 'total membership' means the total number of members comprising the House irrespective of fact whether there are vacancies or absentees. **The provisions which can be amended by this way includes: (i) Fundamental Rights; (ii) Directive Principles of State Policy**

Q 84.D

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Attorney General is the highest law officer in the country. The Attorney General (AG) is appointed by the President. He must be a person who is qualified to be appointed a judge of the Supreme Court.
- **Statement 2 is not correct.** The remuneration of the AG is not fixed by the Constitution. He receives such remuneration as the President may determine.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** He has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings of both the Houses of Parliament or their joint sitting and any committee of the Parliament of which he may be named a member but without a right to vote.

Q 85.A

- Article 19(2) provides that reasonable restrictions can be imposed on exercise of Freedom of Speech and expression under the following conditions: the sovereignty and integrity of India, the security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, decency or morality, or in relation to contempt of court, defamation or incitement to an offence.
 - Leaking classified material by Intelligence officer. - can compromise security of state
 - Giving speech to take up arms - public order
 - Speech which can hamper stability of government in Lok Sabha - it does not fall under any criteria and hence would not be a reasonable restriction
 - Contempt of Court.

Q 86.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct** as it is a part of the Socialist principles but not Gandhian principles.
- **Statement 2 is not correct** as it is also a part of Socialist principles.
- **Statement 3 is correct** as Gandhiji had always advocated the self-governance model through village Panchayats.

Q 87.A

- Article 22 grants protection to persons who are arrested or detained. Detention is of two types, namely, punitive and preventive. Punitive detention is to punish a person for an offence committed by him after trial and conviction in a court. Preventive detention, on the other hand, means detention of a person without trial and conviction by a court. Its purpose is not to punish a person for a past offence but to prevent him from committing an offence in the near future.
- Article 22 has two parts—the first part deals with the cases of ordinary law and the second part deals with the cases of preventive detention law.
- The second part of Article 22 grants protection to persons who are arrested or detained under a preventive detention law. This protection is available to both citizens as well as aliens and includes the following:
 - The detention of a person cannot exceed three months unless an advisory board reports sufficient cause for extended detention. The board is to consist of judges of a high court.**
 - The grounds of detention should be communicated to the detenu. However, the facts considered to be against the public interest need not be disclosed.**
 - The detenu should be afforded an opportunity to make a representation against the detention order.**
- A person has the right to be released after 24 hours (unless the magistrate authorises further detention) only if he is arrested under ordinary law. It is not applicable in case of preventive detention law. **Hence, only statement 3 is correct.**

Q 88.B

- Statement 1 is not correct:** A proclamation of President's Rule may be revoked by the President at any time by a subsequent proclamation. Such a proclamation does not require the parliamentary approval.
- Statement 2 is correct:** The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 introduced a new provision to put restraint on the power of Parliament to extend a proclamation of President's Rule beyond one year. Thus, it provided that, beyond one year, the President's Rule can be extended by six months at a time only when the following two conditions are fulfilled: 1. a proclamation of National Emergency should be in operation in the whole of India, or in the whole or any part of the state; and 2. the Election Commission must certify that the general elections to the legislative assembly of the concerned state cannot be held on account of difficulties.

Q 89.A

- By the Indian Independence Act of 1947, the Assembly was made a fully sovereign body, which could frame any constitution it pleased. The act empowered the Assembly to abrogate or alter any law made by the British Parliament in relation to India.
- The representatives of the princely states, who had stayed away from the constituent Assembly, gradually joined in.

Q 90.D

- Option (a) is correct.** This act divided the Provincial subjects into two parts- transferred and reserved. Transferred subjects were to be administered by the governor with the help of ministers while the reserved list was to be administered by a governor and his executive council. This was termed a dual system of governance or Diarchy.
- Option (b) is correct.** It replaced Indian Legislative Council with a Bicameral legislature consisting of two houses. The elections to both the houses were largely by direct elections.
- Option (c) is correct.** It separated, for the first time, provincial budgets from the Central budget and authorized the provincial legislatures to enact their budgets.
- Option (d) is not correct.** The separate electorate for Muslims was introduced in the act of **1909** itself. This provision was extended to Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo Indians, and Europeans.

Q 91.D

- What is the Statue of Equality?**
 - The world's second tallest statue in a sitting position is made up of 'panchaloha', meaning a combination of five metals i.e. gold, copper, silver, brass, and zinc. The inner sanctum deity of Sri Ramanujacharya is built of 120 kilos of gold. This commemorates the 120 years the saint spent on earth.
- About Sri Ramanujacharya:**
 - Born in 1017 CE in Tamil Nadu.
 - He is the most respected Acharya in the philosophy of Sri Vaishnavism.

- He was also **referred to as Ilaya Perumal** which means the radiant one.
- His philosophical foundations for devotionals were influential to the Bhakti movement.
- He is famous as the **chief proponent of Vishishtadvaita subschool of Vedānta**.
- **He wrote influential texts, such as bhāṣya on the Brahma Sutras and the Bhagavad Gita, all in Sanskrit. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**
- **What is Vishishtadvaita?**
 - It is a non-dualistic school of Vedanta philosophy. It is non-dualism of the qualified whole, in which Brahman alone exists, but is characterized by multiplicity.
 - It can be described as qualified monism or qualified non-dualism or attributive monism.
 - It is a school of Vedanta philosophy that believes in all diversity subsuming to an underlying unity.

Q 92.D

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Though the Indian Constitution is federal and envisages a dual polity (Centre and states), it provides for only a single citizenship, that is, the Indian citizenship (like in Canada). The citizens in India owe allegiance only to the Union. There is no separate state citizenship. The other federal states like USA and Switzerland, on the other hand, adopted the system of double citizenship.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** In India both a citizen by birth as well as a naturalised citizen are eligible for the office of President while in USA, only a citizen by birth and not a naturalised citizen is eligible for the office of President.

Q 93.A

- One thing that has had a long lasting effect on the evolution of the Indian Constitution is the theory of the **basic structure** of the Constitution. The Judiciary advanced this theory in the famous case of **Kesavananda Bharati** in 1973. This ruling has contributed to the evolution of the Constitution in the following ways:
 - It has set specific limits to Parliament's power to amend the Constitution. It says that no amendment can violate the basic structure of the Constitution;
 - It allows Parliament to amend any and all parts of the Constitution (within this limitation); and
 - It places the Judiciary as the final authority in deciding if an amendment violates basic structure and what constitutes the basic structure.
- The theory of basic structure is an example of a **living constitution**. There is no mention of this theory in the Constitution. It has emerged from judicial interpretation. Thus, the Judiciary and its interpretation have practically amended the Constitution without a formal amendment. All living documents evolve in this manner through debates, arguments, competition and practical politics.
- Since 1973, the Court has, in many cases, elaborated upon this theory of basic structure and given instances of what constitutes the basic structure of the Constitution of India. So, the basic structure doctrine has further **consolidated the balance between rigidity and flexibility**: by saying that certain parts cannot be amended, it has underlined the rigid nature while by allowing amendments to all others it has underlined the flexible nature of the amending process.

Q 94.D

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** This limitation is imposed only on criminal laws and not on civil laws or tax laws. In other words, civil liability or a tax can be imposed retrospectively.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Protection against self-incrimination does not extend to (i) compulsory production of material objects, (ii) compulsion to give thumb impression, specimen signature, blood specimens, and (iii) compulsory exhibition of the body.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Protection against double jeopardy is available only in proceedings before a court of law or a judicial tribunal. In other words, it is not available in proceedings before departmental or administrative authorities as they are not of judicial nature.

Q 95.A

- Constitutionalism is all about limited government. It means that powers given to the government are not unlimited but they are limited. **Fundamental rights act as limitations on the government powers** like state must respect citizens' right to express, speech, liberty. If the government did not respect these rights then the aggrieved citizen can approach the judiciary for their enforcement. In this context, they can act as constraints.
- But **Directive Principles of state policy cannot act as constraints/limitations on the government** because they are not enforceable and they are fundamental **to the governance of a country**.

- **Fundamental duties are in fact constraints/limitations on the part of citizens not on the government.** Hence fundamental duties do not limit the working of the government.

Q 96.B

- Articles 358 and 359 describe the effect of a National Emergency on Fundamental Rights. Article 358 deals with the suspension of the Fundamental Rights guaranteed by Article 19, while Article 359 deals with the suspension of other Fundamental Rights (except those guaranteed by Articles 20 and 21).
- According to Article 358, when a proclamation of national emergency is made, the six Fundamental Rights under Article 19 are automatically suspended. No separate order for their suspension is required.
- The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 restricted the scope of Article 358 in two ways.
 - Firstly, **the six Fundamental Rights under Article 19 can be suspended only when the National Emergency is declared on the ground of war or external aggression and not on the ground of armed rebellion. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - Secondly, only those laws which are related to the Emergency are protected from being challenged and not other laws. Also, the executive action taken only under such a law is protected.
- **Article 359 authorizes the president to suspend the right to move any court for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights during a National Emergency. (Hence statement 2 is correct).** This means that under Article 359, the Fundamental Rights as such are not suspended, but only their enforcement. The said rights are theoretically alive but the right to seek remedy is suspended. The suspension of enforcement relates to only those Fundamental Rights that are specified in the Presidential Order. Further, the suspension could be for the period during the operation of emergency or for a shorter period as mentioned in the order, and the suspension order may extend to the whole or any part of the country. It should be laid before each House of Parliament for approval.
- The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 restricted the scope of Article 359 in two ways.
 - Firstly, **the President cannot suspend the right to move the Court for the enforcement of fundamental rights guaranteed by Articles 20 to 21.** In other words, the right to protection in respect of conviction for offenses (Article 20) and the right to life and personal liberty (Article 21) remain enforceable even during an emergency. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - Secondly, only those laws which are related to the emergency are protected from being challenged and not other laws and the executive action taken only under such a law, is protected.

Q 97.A

- Originally, the Constitution of India did not make any provision with respect to the Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities. Later, the States Reorganisation Commission (1953-55) made a recommendation in this regard. Accordingly, **the Seventh Constitutional Amendment Act of 1956 inserted a new Article 350-B in Part XVII of the Constitution. Hence, statement 1 is correct.** This article contains the following provisions:
 - There should be a Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities. He is to be appointed by the President of India.
 - **It would be the duty of the Special Officer to investigate all matters only relating to the safeguards provided for linguistic minorities under the Constitution.**
- He would report to the President upon those matters at such intervals as the President may direct. The President should place all such reports before each House of Parliament and send to the governments of the states concerned. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 98.D

- The government has made many policies and laws to implement the DPSP's.
- **Option 1 is correct** as article 41 talks about securing the right to work, to education and to public assistance in cases of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement.
- **Option 2 is correct:** as it is aimed to implement Article 50 which explicitly calls for the separation of judiciary and the executive. The Criminal Procedure Code (1973) separated the judiciary from the executive in the public services of the state. Thus, the judicial powers vested with the district authorities like Collectors, Tehsildars etc was taken away.
- **Option 3 is correct:** as it is aimed to implement Article 48 under the DPSP's which calls for the modernization of Agriculture and Animal Husbandry.
- **Option 4 is correct:** as it is aimed to provide living wages and work opportunities. Article 41 calls for providing Right to work while Article 43 calls for provision of living wages to all workers.

Q 99.B

- NITI Aayog houses a number of specialised wings, including:
 - **Research Wing:** It develops in-house sectoral expertise as a dedicated think tank of top notch domain experts, specialists and scholars.
 - **Consultancy Wing:** It provides a market-place of whetted panels of expertise and funding, for the Central and State Governments to tap into matching their requirements with solution providers, public and private, national and international. By playing match-maker instead of providing the entire service itself, NITI Aayog is able to focus its resources on priority matters, providing guidance and an overall quality check to the rest.
 - **Team India Wing:** It comprises of the representatives from every State and Ministry and serves as a permanent platform for national collaboration. Each representative:
 - ✓ Ensures that every State/Ministry has a continuous voice and stake in the NITI Aayog.
 - ✓ Establishes a direct communication channel between the State/Ministry and NITI Aayog for all development related matters, as the dedicated liaison interface.

Q 100.D

- The Constitution of India provides certain rights in form of Equalities or Equal treatment to its citizens. These rights are incorporated as Fundamental Rights in the Constitution. These Equalities include:
 - Equality of Status: Equality of Status implies that all citizens have the same status in certain respects, including civil rights, freedom of speech, property rights etc. Articles 17 and 18 aim at providing Equality of Status. Article 17 abolishes Untouchability and Article 18 prohibits awarding of titles.
 - Equality of Opportunity: Equality of Opportunity arises from the similar treatment of all people, unhindered by prejudices or preferences, except when particular distinctions can be explicitly justified. It means that chances for advancement should be open to everybody interested. The Constitution aims to achieve this by providing reservation in educational institutes and public employment (Articles 15 and 16 respectively) to the disadvantaged sections of society.
 - Equality before Law: This is a fundamental principle included in Rule of Law. It implies that every citizen is equal in the eyes of law. Article 14 explicitly provides for Equality before law and Equal protection of laws.
 - Equality of Outcomes: It describes a state in which people have approximately the same material wealth and income, or in which the general economic conditions of their lives are alike. The Constitution does not provide for Equality of Outcomes.
- **Hence, options 1, 2 and 4 are correct but option 3 is not correct.**

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